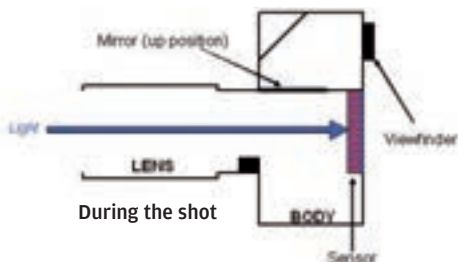


image bounces off the lower mirror, passes through the translucent glass and into the pentaprism. What the prism does, is invert the

received image on the screen, which, in turn means setting the image straight. This image now is visible to you through your viewfinder, right side up.



The Shutter Mechanism

When you push down the shutter release on your P&S, the shutter opens up, exposes the sensor to the light for the required duration and shuts again. With the dSLR, however, it's not as simple. As you have seen already, there's a mirror blocking the light from the sensor at the back of the camera. When you click the shutter button, the camera switches the mirror out of the path of the light and directly onto the image sensor (more about sensors later in this chapter). The timer keeps the shutter open for the appropriate exposure and duration. The second shutter then moves in and the mirror flips back into its original position. This can occur as rapidly as ten times in a second, or even faster.

Although, for the split second that your camera takes the picture, the viewfinder blacks out because there is no image being sent through at all, the good thing is that you know exactly what the picture looked like when you took it. Besides, dSLRs come with their own LCD displays too, which show you the photo you've taken, allow you to take another one if you're not happy with the first. Some current models even allow you live preview the way compact digital cameras do, allowing you to verify the focus, framing and depth of field even before you click.

There are several advantages to the dSLR system:

- a. Shutter lag is minimal, making action and sports photography smoother.
- b. The view is free from parallax.